



*The truth is
out there...*



Since **Aristotle**, many other people have tried to *define* **life**, but there is always something **non-living** that manages to *slip through a crack* in every argument.

Perhaps we won't really be able to say what **life** is until we find it *elsewhere* in the **Universe**. All we have to go on at the moment is our knowledge of what life is like *on our planet*. As far as we know, life exists on Earth and nowhere else.

However, the “ingredients” of life have been found in space, and so there may be other life forms out there. Life may look and behave *differently* elsewhere. Ultimately, we may have to change our whole way of *thinking* about **what life is**.

FEATURES OF LIFE

There are certain KEY THINGS that scientists agree define life. For *something to be living* it must:

- Be organized into a shape (for example, a body) with everything inside it working together
- Take in energy and expend it
- Grow, develop, and change
- Reproduce and pass on useful characteristics to its offspring
- Respond to conditions such as light, wind, heat, and water
- Evolve over generations to adapt to its environment.

